

Alternatives to college

There are plenty of exciting routes for people who feel that college isn't for them. Some options teach teens skills needed in the working world, while others provide exciting life experiences that teens will never forget.

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Options for teens

While some teens feel college is right for them, others prefer to take a different route to achieving their goals. There are many different options and opportunities available. Teens can learn job-specific skills at college or through an apprenticeship or internship. Some teens plan to volunteer, others want to travel, and some start building their career by entering the world of work right away. Each route offers its own mix of advantages and disadvantages, so teens should carefully consider their options before making a decision.

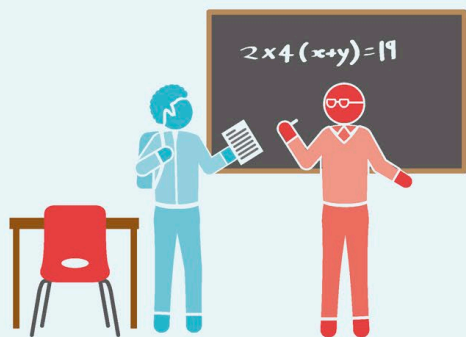
TEEN HINTS

Differing views

All of these options are exciting and provide great experience for a resume, but sometimes people disagree about what the future should hold. If you and your parents don't agree on your future plans, it's a good idea to schedule time to sit down as a family when everyone is calm and has thought about what they want to say in advance. Reassure them that you have thought carefully about the pros and cons of each option, and that you've taken their views into account.

Studying at college

Colleges and vocational schools (also called trade schools) train people in practical, work-related skills that are associated with a particular job. Originally, these schools focused on training people for technical subjects, such as metal working or plumbing, but some colleges now offer academic subjects.



△ Vocational college

These colleges offer teens the chance to study a variety of subjects at a higher level.

Being an apprentice

Working with a company or organization as a full-time employee means teens receive formal, on-the-job training that can lead to work-based qualifications. Some apprenticeships can lead to degrees and professional qualifications.



△ Learning on the job

Earning money and learning new skills at the same time is a great opportunity to build independence.